JAMES CHRISTOPHER FLETCHER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data scientist with 10 years of experience building machine learning systems that solve real business problems. I've spent the last 5 years leading data science teams at growth-stage companies, focusing on predictive modelling and operational analytics. I'm most interested in projects that balance statistical rigor with practical deployment constraints, and I enjoy mentoring junior data scientists through complex problems.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Scientist

Catalyst Analytics

www.catalystanalytics.io

Bristol, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led a team of 4 data scientists developing predictive models for customer churn and lifetime value across a portfolio of 8 SaaS products. Designed and implemented an ML pipeline using Python and PySpark that reduced model training time from 6 hours to 22 minutes, enabling weekly retraining cycles. Built automated monitoring systems to detect model drift in production, catching 3 significant performance degradations before they impacted business decisions. Established best practices for experiment design across the team, resulting in 40% faster hypothesis validation and more rigorous A/B testing protocols.

Data Science Manager

Momentum Capital Ltd

www.momentumcapital.co.uk

London, United Kingdom

August 2018 - February 2021

Managed a team of 6 data scientists and 2 analysts working on algorithmic trading models and market microstructure analysis. Developed a gradient boosting model for intraday price prediction that improved trading signal accuracy by 12%, contributing approximately GBP 2.3m in additional annual profit. Oversaw the migration of legacy statistical models to a modern Python stack, establishing reproducible workflows and reducing model deployment time from 4 weeks to 3 days. Took on responsibility for hiring and onboarding, building a high-performing team that won the company's innovation award in 2020.

Data Scientist

Beacon Insights Ltd

beacon-insights.net

Bristol, United Kingdom

July 2013 - July 2018

Developed machine learning models for retail demand forecasting, inventory optimization, and customer segmentation used by 40+ retail clients. Built an ensemble forecasting system combining ARIMA, Prophet, and XGBoost models that reduced inventory holding costs by 8% across the client base while improving stock availability. Implemented end-to-end data pipelines using Python, SQL, and AWS services to automate feature

engineering and model retraining. Worked directly with clients on model interpretation and deployment, translating technical findings into actionable business recommendations that led to contract renewals and 3 major upsells.

EDUCATION

MSc Data Science

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

Completed 2013

BSc Mathematics with Statistics

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Completed 2011

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, R, SQL, Scala

Machine Learning Libraries: scikit-learn, XGBoost, LightGBM, TensorFlow, PyTorch

Big Data: PySpark, Hadoop, AWS (EC2, S3, SageMaker, Redshift)

Data Processing: pandas, NumPy, Polars, Spark SQL

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Snowflake

Experiment Design: A/B testing, statistical hypothesis testing, causal inference

Visualization: Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly, Tableau

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Other: Docker, Airflow, Jenkins, Jupyter, Linux